

Handling Tips For Projectors

A projector is a costly piece of equipment. Even costlier is the running cost. Maintaining and handling it with care is very important. Here are a few tips:

- ❑ Handle a projector gently. Always remember that it has a lens and an electronic assembly within. A jolt can disrupt the assembly of the lens, which will result in barrel distortion and keystone aberrations
- ❑ Never switch-off the main power after switching off your projector. This is because an internal fan, which is needed to cool the lamp and associated electronics, rotates for at least a minute after powering down. This is needed to flush out hot air from the projector. Avoid disrupting the process
- ❑ To continue with the above point, never pack up a projector immediately after using it even if you have used it for a short time. Leave it in the open for some time, and let it vent heat
- ❑ Never twist a projector's cables, especially the data cables. Try to fold them in the manner in which they arrived. Needless twisting will damage the cords, which might result in malfunctioning
- ❑ Make sure you wrap a portable projector in a bubble bag before lugging it around

When we looked for crispness of text and contrast between black fonts and white background, we found that all the projectors were more or less the same, with very little visible difference. Some models such as the HP vp6110 and the Toshiba TDP-S20 lagged in contrast when the background wasn't completely white. The Epson, Canon, Sharp and Infocus, on the other hand, had good control on brightness and contrast, imparting clarity to the slides.

In the reverse text test (in 'Presentation' mode), the Sony VPL-ES2 and the Canon LV-S3 fared better than the other projectors including the DLPs. Here, yellow text on blue background was reproduced well by both Sony and Canon. The HP vp6110 was the only DLP projector to score high in this test. The rest couldn't reproduce the yellow as well. Same was the case with the slide with "radium" green colour text on a blue background. If your work includes a presentation or if you handle education-related slides with text on various coloured backgrounds, make sure you choose an LCD projector such as the Sony or the Canon; otherwise, when creating slides, use colours that don't appear saturated—such as black or purple on a yellow background.

Performance While Displaying Graphs

Our coloured 3D bar graph had two shades of blue and a light shade of green. The Acer PD113 and the BenQ PB6100 displayed a darker shade of what was projected. Moreover, the side surface of the 3D bars appeared black. This happened after we completely filled the screen with the graph, using PowerPoint's animation feature. The other projectors fared well in this colour reproduction test.

Under our animation test, we looked for fluid animation, good colour reproduction and crispness of text. Here again, the Canon LV-S3 managed good scores. The HP vp6110, a DLP unit, fared equally well. The Infocus, Sharp and Acer, however, showcased issues—the colour shade appeared different under them and the text was therefore not easily readable.

Performance While Displaying Movies



Canon LV-S3

1/2 pg V AD